

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 6

- POST-HARAPPAN ARCHITECTURE
- VEDIC PHASE
- MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

POST-URBAN PHASE OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE



Chalcolithic period of Post-Harappan culture

- 1 The Harappan culture seems to have flourished until 1900 B.C.
- 2 Afterwards its urban phase marked by systematic town planning, extensive brick work, art of script, standard weights and measures, distinction between the citadel and the lower town, use of bronze tools, and, red ware pottery painted with black designs practically disappeared.
- 3 The post-urban phase of the Harappan culture is also known as the **sub-Indus culture** or the **late Harappan culture**.
- 4 The late Harappan culture is **primarily chalcolithic** in which tools of stone and copper are used.

POST-URBAN PHASE OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE



Swat valley in Pakistan

- 5 They do not show metal objects requiring complicated casting.
- 6 The chalcolithic people in the late Harappan phase lived in villages subsisting on agriculture, stock raising, hunting and fishing.
- 7 The post-urban Harappan settlements have been discovered in the Swat valley.
- 8 Here the people practised a developed agriculture and cattle breeding together with pastoralism.

POST-URBAN PHASE OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE



Black-grey burnished ware

- 9** They used black-grey burnished ware produced on a slow wheel.
- 10** The painted Harappan pottery found in the late Harappan phase lacked the intricate designs which were present in the Harappan phase.
- 11** In the late Harappan phase no object for measuring the length is noticed. Also some places lacked the cubical stone weights which were present in the Harappan phase.

POST-URBAN PHASE OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE



- 12** Generally all late Harappan sites lack human figurines and characteristic painted designs.
- 13** The post-urban phase of Harappa saw the end of the Indus trade with the West Asian centres.
- 14** Lapis lazuli, chert, carnelian beads and copper and bronze vessels are either absent or scarce as trade items.
- 15** All this was natural because most late Harappan sites excavated in Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh are **mostly rural settlements**.

POST-URBAN PHASE OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

16 In the last phase of Harappan culture, **few signs of insecurity and violence** seem to have appear.

17 New types of axes, daggers, knives with midribs appear in the upper levels of Mohenjadarro.

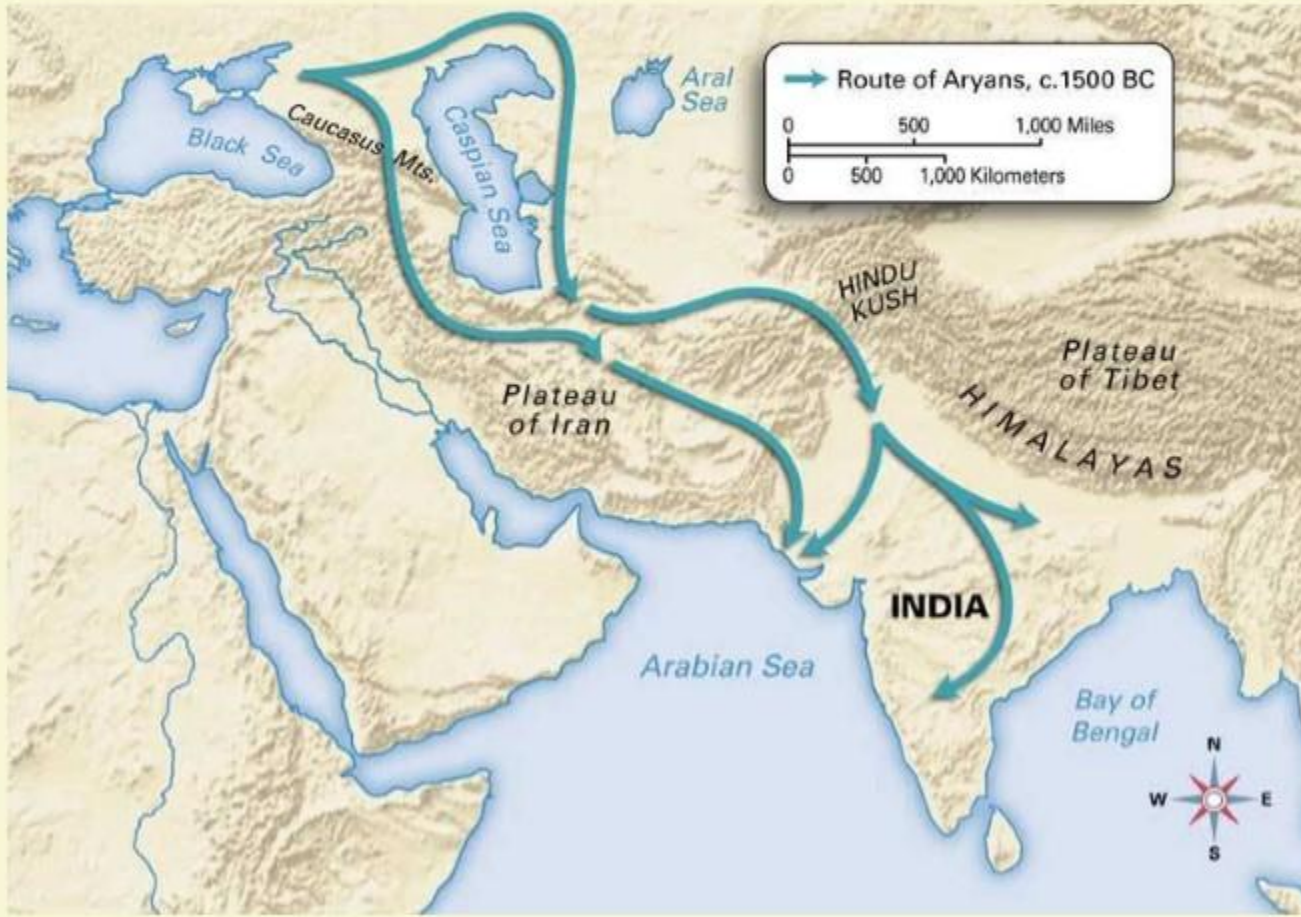
18 **Hoard**s of **jewellery** were buried at places and **skulls** were huddled together at one place.

19 Some **foreign intrusion** and traces of new people seem to have happened in the late Harappan phase.

20 At several places, **Grey Ware (GW) & Painted Grey Ware (PGW)**, generally associated with the Vedic people, have been found in conjunction with some late Harappan pottery.

21 All this can be attributed to the **barbarian horse-riding people** who may have come from Iran- THE ARYANS.

POST-URBAN PHASE OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE



Possible route taken by Aryans

- 22** But the Aryans did not come in such numbers as to completely overwhelm the Harappan cities.
- 23** The Vedic Aryans settled down mostly in the land of the Seven Rivers, in which, the Harappan culture once flourished.
- 24** We do not have any archaeological evidence of any mass-scale confrontation between the mature Harappans and the Aryans.

TIMELINE

HARAPPAN CIVILIZATION

- Early Phase- Approximately 4000 BC to 2550 BC
- Mature phase- 2550 BC to 1900 BC
- Late Phase- 1900 BC to 1500 BC

VEDIC PHASE

1500 BC to 1000 BC

LATER VEDIC PHASE

1000 BC to 500 BC

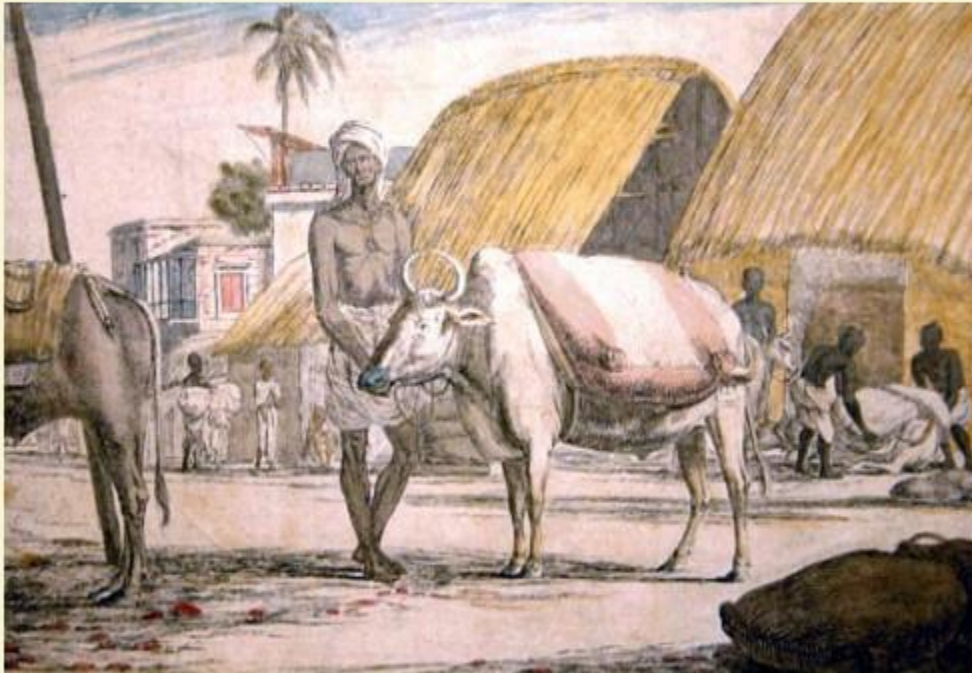
MAHAJANAPADAS; RISE AND GROWTH OF MAGADHAN EMPIRE

600 BC to 320 BC

MAURYAN EMPIRE

320 BC to 232 BC

ARCHITECTURES OF THE VEDIC ARYANS



1 The Vedic Aryans who came next lived in houses built of **wood, bamboo and reeds**; the Aryan culture was largely a rural one, and thus **one finds few examples of grand buildings.**

2 This was because Aryans used **perishable materials** like wood for the construction of royal palaces, which have **been completely destroyed over time.**

ARCHITECTURES OF THE VEDIC ARYANS



Usage of fire altars in the Vedic Period

3 The most important feature of the Vedic period was the **making of fire altars**, which soon became an important and integral part of the social and religious of people even today.

4 In many Hindu homes, and especially in their marriages, these fire altars play an important role even today.

5 Soon courtyard and mandaps were built with **altars for worship of fire**, which was the most important feature of Vedic architecture.

ARCHITECTURES OF THE VEDIC ARYANS



Gurukuls were a feature of Vedic Period

- 6 We also find references of Gurukuls and Hermitages.
- 7 Unfortunately, no structure of the Vedic period remains to be seen.
- 8 Their contribution to the architectural history is the use of wood along with brick and stone for building their houses.

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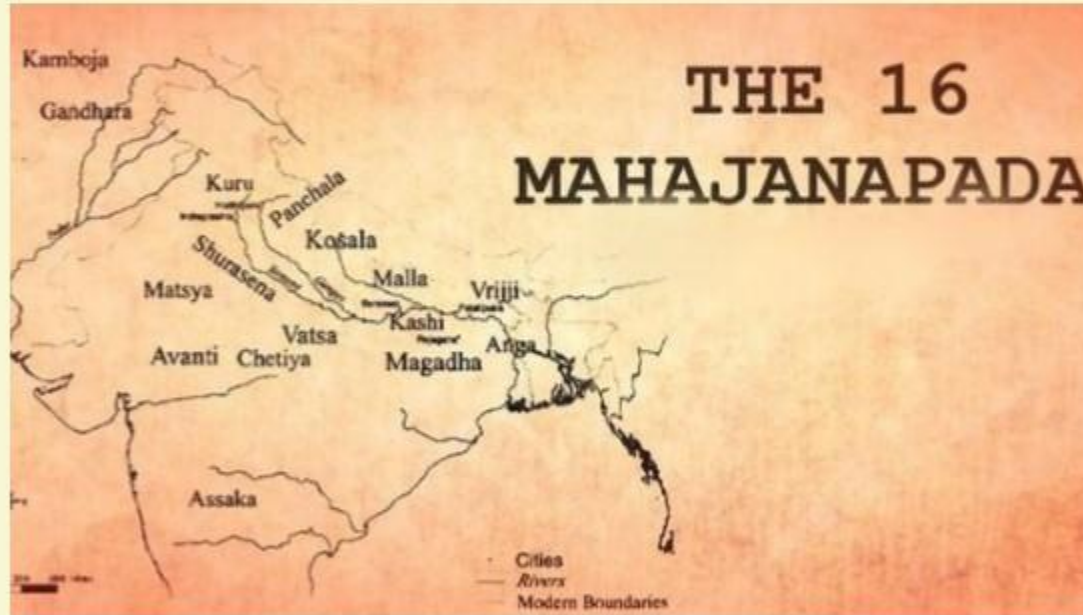
RISE AND GROWTH OF MAHAJANAPADAS



Growth of Kshatriya class

- 1 From the sixth century B.C. onwards the widespread use of iron created conditions for formation of large territorial States.
- 2 Because of iron weapons the warrior class i.e., Kshatriyas now played an important part.
- 3 The new agricultural tools and implements also strengthened the growth of agriculture.
- 4 People owed strong allegiance to land or the territory to which they belong and thus grew the concept of Janapadas that is the raise of large States with towns as their base of operations.

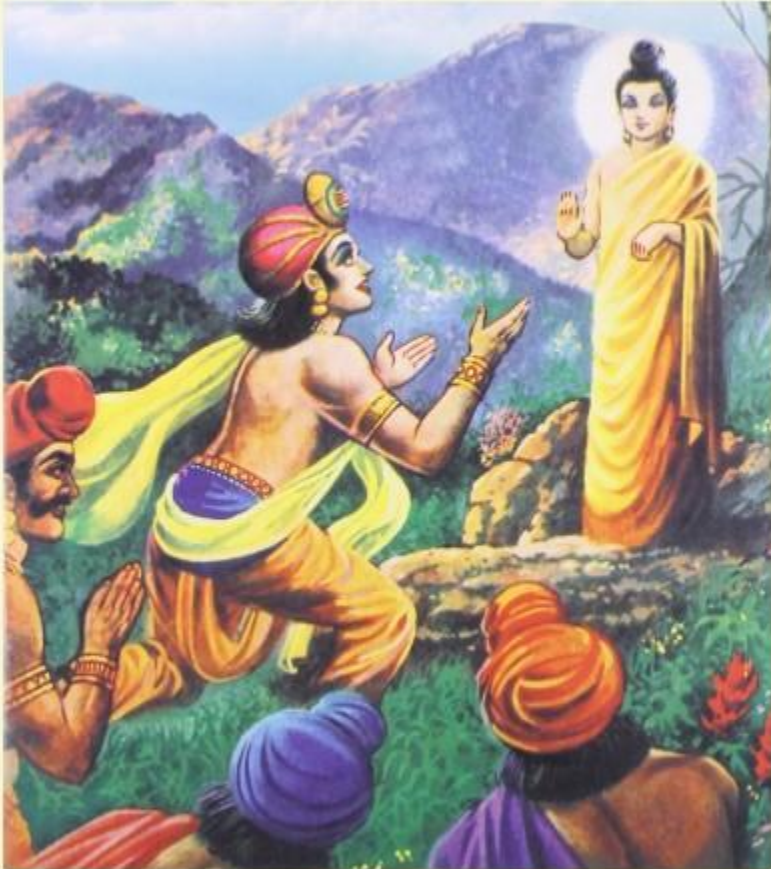
RISE AND GROWTH OF MAHAJANAPADAS



Growth of Mahajanapadas in India

- 5 In the age of Buddha we find 16 large States called Mahajanapadas.
- 6 The political history of India from the sixth century B.C. onwards is the history of struggles between these Mahajanapadas for supremacy.
- 7 Ultimately the kingdom of Magadha emerged to be the most powerful and succeeded in founding an empire.

RISE AND GROWTH OF THE MAGADHAN EMPIRE



Artistic depiction of Bimbisara and his contemporary Buddha

- 1** Magadha came in to prominence under the leadership of Bimbisara.
- 2** He was a contemporary of Buddha.
- 3** He started the policy of conquest and aggression which ended with the Kalinga war of Ashoka.
- 4** Emergence of this strong Magadhan empire helped in the growth of Buddhism and Jainism.
- 5** From now onwards it was possible to trace Indian architecture in an almost unbroken sequence.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE



- 1 With the advent of the Buddhism and Jainism which were part of the Shramana tradition, the religious and social scenario of Gangetic valley began to undergo changes.
- 2 As both the religions were opposed to the varna and jati system of Vedic Age, they gained patronage of the Kshatriya rulers who have grown wary of brahmanical supremacy.
- 3 Thus, the Buddhist and Jain architectures began to see an immense growth under the kingship of Kshatriya rulers like Mauryas.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE



1st century BC relief from Sanchi, showing Ashoka on his chariot

- 4 From now, onwards **the religion began to influence architecture.**
- 5 The patronization of Buddhism by Mauryan kings particularly, by Ashoka greatly influenced the religious and political atmosphere as well as art and culture.
- 6 As such the Mauryan Art and Culture bears a **distinct Buddhist stamp** on it as seen in stupas, chaityas, viharas, pillars and capitals, rock-cut architecture, cave architecture and sculptures.
- 7 These elements of Mauryan Architecture are discussed below.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE



- 1 Viharas
- 2 Chaityas
- 3 Pillars and Capitals
- 4 Stupas
- 5 Sculptures
- 6 Rock-cut Caves
- 7 Palaces
- 8 Pottery



MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

1

VIHARAS



Viharas in Ajanta caves

1

The Viharas were places of residence or monasteries of Buddhist monks particularly, for taking shelter during the rainy season.

2

The erstwhile kingdom of Magada had a large number of Viharas giving it the name “Bihar”.

3

Initial Viharas were simple wooden structures, which do not survive to this day. However, some of the Viharas do exist in the rock-cut structures in the Ajanta, Ellora, Karle, Nashik, Badami and Kanheri caves among others.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

1

VIHARAS



4

Many of such Viharas have almost a standard or a common plan. It could have a **quadrangular court** with **walls flanking it**.

5

Small cells would be present around the central court. These cells would have **stone beds**, a raised portion of which would serve as a **pillow**.

6

A small hole in the wall of the cell would be a space for keeping an **earthen lamp**.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

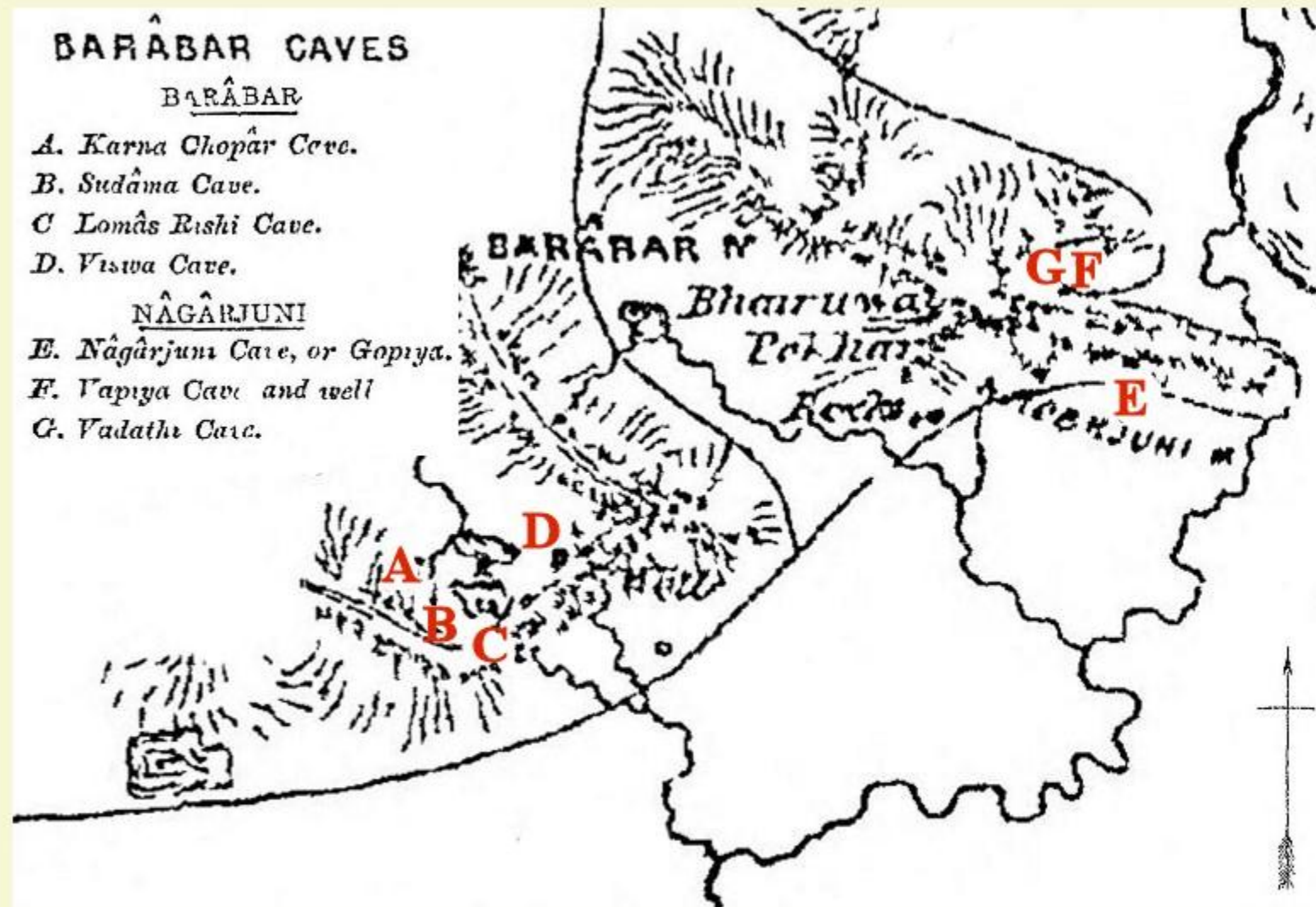
2

CHAITYAS



Lomus Rishi caves in Barabar Hills

- 1 These were the **Buddhist shrines or prayer halls** with the stupa at one end of the hall and pillars on the side of the pathway are leading to the stupa.
- 2 They were also **community places of worship for the Buddhist.**
- 3 The rock-cut Chaityas, which exist even today are seen in **Ajanta, Ellora, Karle, Nashik and Kanheri caves.**
- 4 Many of these were also constructed in the **Post-Mauryan period.** However, the **Chaityas at Barabar and Nagarjuni Caves** are examples of Mauryan Art.



**Map of Barabar caves showing the “twin caves” of both
 Barabar and Nagarjuni**

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